

UNLEASHED LEADERS TRAINING NOTES

Three implementations of Unleashed Leaders onboarding, each with a specific context in mind. This manuscript is a **general plan of what to cover each session**—the slides and booklet align with these notes.

01 LARGE GROUP

GROUPS LARGER THAN 15

Usually a good option to kick off a school year, when the most new leaders are coming aboard. Offers the chance to create table conversations and break points during the training. Typically a stand-alone training day and time.

02 SMALL GROUP

GROUPS OF 3-14

Usually still sitting in one circle. Likely used post Leader Night and pre Leader Celebration when a fair number of potential leaders have shown interest—or after a membership class where several people show interest in student ministry. Easily paired with ministry time (a breakout during group / program time).

03 1 ON 1 / FEW

SPORADIC INTEREST, YEAR-ROUND

We never want a lengthy amount of time to pass when helping someone jump into our ministry. Use this option when new leader interest arrives sporadically throughout the year—walk them through the booklet one-on-one.

BEFORE YOU TRAIN

This training utilizes the 4 Chair Discipling framework (Dann Spader) alongside the Unleashed Leaders booklet. Room set up each week: water, pen, booklet, handouts. Pre-show: looping video (Mission · Vision · Title) and introduce the staff team present. **Staff note:** use the 4 Chair Inventory in your interview to help identify where someone is.

LARGE GROUP - WEEK 1

WEEK 1 Disciple Def. • Model • Mission • Motive • Method

Minutes in orange

5 SET UP — leaving here today we hope you...

- Get a clearer picture of Jesus • of a disciple • feel ready for student ministry to be your place to be unleashed. Share personally: the adventure Christ invited you into as a leader.

5 INTRO — puzzle illustration

- Dollar-store puzzle per table, no box. **2 min:** most puzzle done wins a prize (at Leader Launch). Today we show the box cover—a clear picture of a disciple.
- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** In your own words, define “disciple.” Use experiences from your own life.

2 DISCIPLE (DEF.) — read Matthew 28:18–20

- One who **KNOWS** God personally and **PURSUES** Jesus passionately, modeling everything in their life after the **character** and **priorities** of Christ.
- Knows = relationship with God • Pursues = following with everything • Character = growing Christ-likeness • Priorities = disciple-making cues from Jesus.

3 LEADER (DEF.) — read Luke 9:62; 10:1–2

- A disciple who **GRIPS THE PLOW** and becomes a **HARVEST WORKER**. God unleashes a specific purpose in each person for kingdom impact.

10 MODEL — Jesus’ life is our model

- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** What does it mean to “walk as Jesus walked”? — 1 John 2:6.
- **Command C & V:** Jesus is our model; copy His character and priorities, paste them into our own life.

10 MISSION — Jesus sets our mission

- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** Why did Jesus come to earth? What was His mission?
- **Jesus:** seek & save the lost (Luke 19:10) • make & multiply disciples (Colossians 1:6). **Southeast:** connecting people to Jesus & one another.
- **Stand up** if you’ve been genuinely discipled. **2 min:** share what it looked like. Why student ministry? Someone connected you to Jesus—we get to connect students. Leaders model mission and community.

5 MOTIVE — love for God and people

- 1 John 4:19 “We love because he first loved us” • Matthew 22:37–40 (First Commandment).
- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** What motivated Jesus? What motivates us?

20 METHOD — relational • intentional • missional

- **4 min:** 3 notecards per person—RELATIONAL / INTENTIONAL / MISSIONAL. Jot Scripture from Jesus’ life for each.
- **Relational** “Come follow me” • **Intentional** “I will make you” • **Missional** “Fish for men.” His plan came through 4 CHALLENGES He initiated with His disciples.
- **DISCUSS 2 MIN** Who is investing in you? Into whom are you investing? You will have your **WHO** and your **WHOM**.

HOMEWORK — 4 Chair Personal Inventory • 40 Days of Disciple-Making journal sample • get familiar with the 4 Chairs / Challenges before next week.

LARGE GROUP • WEEK 2

WEEK 2 Four Chair Disciple • Reach // Build // Equip // Multiply

Have 4 chairs on stage to sit & move in

10 SET UP + 4 CHAIR OVERVIEW

- Recap as needed. **Chair 1** Lost (Luke 15) • **Chair 2** Believer • **Chair 3** Worker • **Chair 4** Disciple-Maker.
- 2 min:** share 4 Chair Inventory results at your tables.

10 CHAIR 1 — “Come and See” • John 1:39 • John 1:46 • John 4:29

- Invitation = come and see who Jesus is. Response = repent and believe.
- Sent on a rescue mission: fishers of people (Mark 1:17) • witnesses (Acts 1:8) • ambassadors (2 Cor 5:20).
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** Who are the lost people crossing your path each day? Write names—add “STUDENTS” as a category.
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** — MS + HS CAMP • ONE NIGHTS • EXPERIENCE WKND (MSM)

10 CHAIR 2 — “Follow Me” • John 1:43 • Luke 9:23 • Luke 9:57

- Challenge = lay down your life and follow Jesus.
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** What does it mean to be a follower? What is expected of one?
- A new disciple learns: identity (in Christ) • how to walk (with Christ) • talk (to God) • feed themselves (God’s Word) • clean themselves (repent).
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** — GROUPS • WEEKEND WORSHIP • FALL RETREAT (HSM)

15 CHAIR 3 — “Fish for Men” • Matthew 4:19 • Luke 10:2

- Challenge = get after the work of ministry and fish for people.
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** How do we know we’re ready to be a harvest worker? What did Jesus look for?
- Count the cost (Luke 9:23). Read Luke 5:1–11 for what Jesus looked for in potential leaders.
- AFT’R more:** **DISCUSS 5 MIN** Am I **Available** to be used by God? **Faithful** to Christ and His call? **Teachable** in actions and attitudes? **Responsive** to the vision of those leading me? (bottom of p.33)
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** — MISSION TRIPS • SERVING

10 CHAIR 4 — “Go and Bear Fruit” • John 15:5

- Challenge = abide in Christ and bear fruit in making disciples.
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** Where are you strongest right now? Where do you need to improve to produce much fruit?
- Chair 4 disciples aren’t just small group leaders—they use every tool, alongside the Holy Spirit, to reach, build, and equip. Share a disciple-making picture from our ministry.
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** — INVESTING IN A FEW: NOT A PROGRAM, A WAY OF LIFE

5 REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY — overview graphic

- Homework: if you didn’t finish the 40 Days journal, keep at it.

SMALL GROUP - WEEK 1

WEEK 1 Disciple Def. • Model • Mission • Motive • Method

Train from the deck or straight from the booklet

5 SET UP — quick get to know you

- Share name + what brought you here. Booklet has a note section—no need to follow along in it.
- **143,556 students in our region.** Most don't know Jesus—but change starts one student at a time.

10 MISSION + VISION — Jesus sets our mission

- **TABLE DISCUSSION** Why did Jesus come to earth? What was His mission?
- **Jesus:** seek & save the lost (Luke 19:10)—*He didn't just flip the light switch on and call it a day* • make & multiply disciples (Colossians 1:6).
- **Southeast's mission:** connecting people to Jesus & one another—rooted in the Great Commission + Great Commandment.
- **Southeast's vision:** unleash the full force of the church to love people one at a time. We make a large church feel small, a large mission tangible. Student ministry is your place of being unleashed.

15 OUR MODEL — Jesus is our model

- **TABLE DISCUSSION** In your own words, define “disciple.” What are some things Jesus did to make disciples?
- **How Jesus did it:** chose Twelve (Lk 6:12–16) • regularly sent (Lk 9:1–6) • engaged the crowd (Lk 9:10–17) • always followed up (Lk 9:18–20) • raised the bar (Lk 9:23–27) • invested in a few (Lk 9:28).
- **What that means for us:** Small Groups—we choose twelve (ish) • Unleash—we send students out • Program—we engage the crowd • Intentionality—we follow up • Expectations—we raise the bar • One at a Time—we invest in a few.

10 TOOLS — what's at our disposal?

- Look at the Tools page together and explain what we offer as an overview.

10 YOUR ROLE — summary of your role (booklet p.12)

- Read through the role summary and extrapolate. Summarize: Shepherd • Harvest Worker • Teammate.
- **1 Peter 5:2 → Shepherd:** be shepherds over God's flock—examples worth following.
- **Luke 10:2 → Harvest Worker:** Luke 9:62 calls us to grip the plow. Be a worker; call others to the work.
- **1 Corinthians 3:5–9 → Teammate:** each plays a part in planting, watering, tilling. God makes it grow—use your gifts for His Kingdom.

HOMEWORK — 4 Chair Personal Inventory (booklet pp.15–16).

SMALL GROUP - WEEK 2

WEEK 2 Four Chair Disciple • 4 Challenges lead to 4 Movements

Have 4 chairs on stage to sit & move in

5 SET UP + 4 CHAIR OVERVIEW

- Recap as needed. **Chair 1** Lost (Luke 15) • **Chair 2** Believer • **Chair 3** Worker • **Chair 4** Disciple-Maker.

10 CHALLENGE 1 — “Come and See” • John 1:39 • John 1:46 • John 4:29

- Andrew tells Simon; Philip tells Nathanael. Invitation = come and see. Response = repent and believe.
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** Who are the lost people that naturally cross your path each day?
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** – MS + HS CAMP • ONE NIGHTS • WORSHIP NIGHTS
- Organically:* we send students every Wed/Sun to reach their schools, homes, and communities.

10 CHALLENGE 2 — “Follow Me” • John 1:43 • Luke 9:23 • Luke 9:57

- Challenge = lay down your life and follow Jesus.
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** What does it mean to be a follower? What is expected of one?
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** – GROUPS • WEEKEND WORSHIP • FALL RETREAT (HSM) • DISCIPLESHIP WKND (MSM)
- Organically:* building happens in the in-between moments—praying and reading with students as we go.

10 CHALLENGE 3 — “Fish for Men” • Matthew 4:19 • Luke 10:2

- Challenge = get after the work of ministry and fish for people.
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** How do we know we’re ready to be a harvest worker? What did Jesus look for?
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** – MISSION TRIPS • SERVING
- Organically:* modeling mission for our students—are we going into the fields or just telling them to?

10 CHALLENGE 4 — “Go and Bear Fruit” • John 15:5

- Challenge = abide in Christ and bear fruit in making disciples.
- DISCUSS 2 MIN** Where are you strongest? Where do you need to improve to produce much fruit?
- Chair 4 disciples aren’t just small group leaders—they use every tool, alongside the Holy Spirit, to reach, build, and equip.
- REACH // BUILD // EQUIP // MULTIPLY** – INVESTING IN A FEW: NOT A PROGRAM, A WAY OF LIFE
- Each chair will be represented in your groups this year.** Your job: help students see where they are and get to what God has next.

HOMEWORK — check with staff on any clearance needs.

WEEK 3 • HSM + MSM SPECIFICS

WEEK 3 Same content for both tracks

Large Group: at a Big 3 event • Small Group: HSM & MSM separate

— VISION SET UP

- Call back to All In.
- Leaders are the backbone.

— COMMITMENTS

- **Weekly** — Groups • **Monthly** — One Nights • **Semesterly** — Camps (Fall, Winter, Summer).
- **Yearly** — Leader Launch, Leader Night, Leader Celebration • **Continual** — Investment in a Few.

— GROUP DETAILS

- Co-leader // Team • School // Grade • Communication.

— PARENT PARTNERSHIPS

- Communication.

— SAFETY

- Red, Yellow, Green Light • Social Media / Online.

TIMING

The third week depends on the time of year—it will be Leader Launch, Leader Night, or Leader Celebration. Leader Launch has a more formal HSM / MSM breakout to offer specific details.

1 ON 1 / FEW

— THE WALK-THROUGH

- There is a booklet for both **MSM** and **HSM**. Use it to walk someone through a general overview of who we are as a ministry and help a potential leader get a feel for our expectations.
- Keep it conversational—the same Mission / Model / Role / 4 Chairs content, sized for a coffee table instead of a stage.

— 4 CHAIR PERSONAL INVENTORY

- Ask the potential leader to fill it out before meeting—or after, sending it back to you.
- The inventory confronts them with questions that identify where they are, and how our ministry can help them as they help others move to the next chair spiritually.

STAFF NOTE

Use the 4 Chair Inventory in your interview to help you identify where someone is. And remember the why behind all three tracks: we never want a lengthy amount of time to pass when someone is ready to jump into our ministry.

COMPANION RESOURCES

Unleashed Leaders Booklet • the training workbook

P1 • Unleashed Leaders Deck • slides aligned to these notes

R12 • 4 Chair Inventory • homework + interviews

R9 • Unleashed Leaders One-Pager • recap & review